

## The Latch

### Hook

A settlement or gateway whose name makes local access feel earned rather than purchased.

### Arrival Read

The Latch feels like a threshold that decides whether access is earned, bought, or refused.

### Known For

A crossing that grips the road like a fist. Oversized locks and crank-wheels clamp a bridge that narrows where the mechanism bites it. Key-charms dangle and clatter in the wind. The whole contraption seems personally offended by anyone in a hurry, and lets...

### What Is Here

Local residents or workers appropriate to the place gear beetles, bridge swallows, crank mice No default combatant; add only if the scene introduces one Local civic, trade, or route interests Food, tools, route signs, local goods, or scene-specific clues...

### Food And Texture

Whoever tends the Latch keeps a kettle and a grudge, and will share both. There is bread and hard cheese and strong tea for those who wait politely, and a markedly longer wait for those who do not.

### You Could

- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

### Export Stamp

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